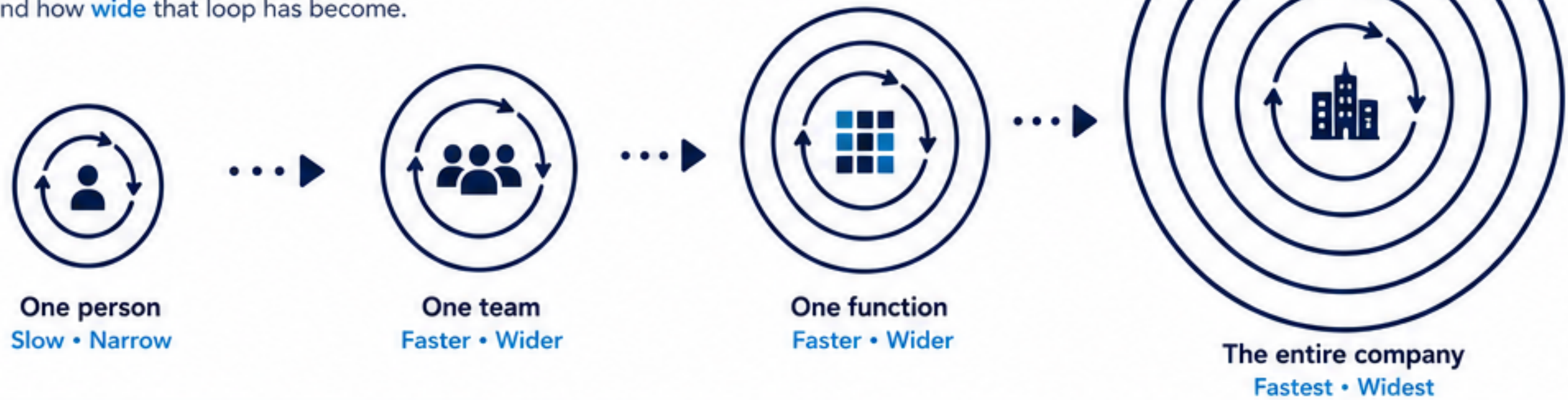


FROM LOOPS TO LEVELS

Every organization runs the **same** learning loop.
These levels show how **fast** and how **wide** that loop has become.



SPEED
How fast the loop runs

×

SURFACE AREA
How many people the loop touches

=

COMPOUNDING
Exponential impact

LEVEL 0 TO LEVEL 5 Where is your organization on the path to becoming a self-driving organization?

	LEVEL 0	LEVEL 1	LEVEL 2	LEVEL 3	LEVEL 4	LEVEL 5
	AI AS THEATER 	INDIVIDUAL AI USE 	TEAM WORKFLOWS 	ORGANIZATIONAL INFRASTRUCTURE 	COMPOUNDING OPERATING SYSTEM 	SELF-DRIVING ORGANIZATION 
WHAT CAN AI SEE?	Nothing structured. Knowledge lives in people's heads, undocumented meetings, and SaaS tools AI can't read.	Each individual's AI sees only what that person feeds it. Private files, saved prompts, personal context.	Teams have shared context. AI sees within team boundaries and team systems.	The whole organization is queryable. Cross-functional context. Systems of record exposed and integrated.	The system sees not just what happens but the relationships between what happens. Continuous capture + synthesis + memory.	Generative visibility. The system asks its own questions, finds gaps, proposes investigations, and runs them.
WHAT CAN AI DO?	Nothing of consequence. Maybe summarize a meeting if a human pastes the transcript.	Help individuals draft, summarize, brainstorm, code. No action on systems of record.	Functional workflows. AI for sales, support, eng review. Bounded actions within the team.	Agents act across systems. Update CRMs, open PRs, route tickets, run analyses, reconcile invoices.	Agents have policy-driven decision authority within scoped domains. Purpose-built harnesses. Remove blockers.	Delegated authority for novel decisions. The system notices it should act and does so.
WHO CAN EXTEND THE SYSTEM?	No one. AI is a personal tool, ungoverned and unintegrated.	Each user reinvents independently. Power users are heroes; their work leaves with them.	Within a team, non-engineers use shared workflows. Across teams, not really.	Non-engineers author and share skills. Workflows packaged and reused across functions.	Non-engineers ship production tools. AE ships a sales tool. Finance builds a contract reviewer. No engineers needed.	Anyone extends the product or reshapes it without writing code. Internal tool and product feature boundaries dissolve.
HOW HAS THE ORGANIZATION CHANGED?	It hasn't. Same chart, same meetings, same reporting, same headcount plans.	It hasn't. Maybe a "Head of AI" and some tools. The org runs the same.	Functional efficiency within roles. More output per person, but org shape unchanged.	Org chart looks different from 2023. New archetypes. Budgets shift to infrastructure. Token-maxing > headcount-maxing.	Hierarchy collapses toward "channel managers" of workflows. Comp is tied to AI proficiency. Signal-to-ship measured in hours.	Truly fluid. Agents are organizational members. Org self-modifies. Knowledge survives transitions perfectly.
HARD TEST	Can AI complete any recurring business process end-to-end?	If your best AI user left tomorrow, would their workflow remain in the company?	Does this workflow cross team boundaries, or is every function building privately?	Can an agent answer across systems: what shipped, who asked, what broke, what customers said, and what we should do next — without a cross-functional meeting?	Show me a workflow that got better because the system learned from prior runs. Plus: show me three production tools shipped by non-engineers this quarter.	What important thing did the company notice, decide, act on, and learn from recently without a human initiating it?
COMMON FALSE POSITIVE	Excellent speeches about AI transformation.	"80% of employees use AI weekly!"	"AI workflows in every department." But they don't connect.	Landfill of transcripts and dashboards with no synthesis.	Agent sprawl. Hundreds of brittle automations. No compaction.	Fake autonomy. Configured rules or alerts, not real generative behavior.

LOW AUTONOMY  HIGH AUTONOMY